WEEK 11 · LECTURE L1 OF 3 · UNIT IV

Strategy for Resilience and Agility

From tools to an operating model, and how to build an HR function that can change itself.

Part 1	From tools to operating model; strategic alignment revisited
Part 2	Resilience and agility; build, measure, learn in HR
Part 3	Bridge to change agency
Read	Westerman et al. (2014), leadership and strategy chapters

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi · DSEH001 · M.Com. PGCF 2025

PART 1 · AN OPERATING MODEL

A strategy is an operating model, not a project list

A project list

Buy an HRIS. Launch a chatbot. Build a dashboard. Each can succeed while the function stays the same.

An operating model

Who decides, how money flows, what is measured, how capability is built. It survives a change of tools.

Element	The question
Structure	Shared services, centers of excellence, business partners?
Decision rights	Who decides on tools, data and policy?
Funding	How does money flow and move?
Measures	Which KPIs and counter metrics?
Capability	What skills does HR itself need?
Governance	How are data and AI risks managed?

PART 2 · RESILIENCE AND AGILITY

Strength to absorb shocks; speed to adapt

Resilience

Absorb disruption, recover, and respond to the specific situation.

Agility

Respond quickly, pivot, and keep learning.

A build, measure, learn step	Not this
Telugu WhatsApp leave flow, Warangal stores, eight weeks	A company-wide chatbot launch
Measure weekly active use and tickets	Measure go-live
Scale, fix or stop rule set in advance	Decide after seeing the results

Going deeper: the theory underneath strategy

The next slides set out Teece on dynamic capabilities, March on exploration and exploitation, Mintzberg on emergent strategy, and Ries on the lean startup: what each claims, how it works, where it breaks, and what it means at GreenLeaf.

THEORY IN DEPTH · TEECE, PISANO AND SHUEN (1997); TEECE (2007)

Dynamic capabilities: the ability to change

THE CORE IDEA

Lasting advantage comes from the capacity to reconfigure resources as the environment shifts.

HOW IT WORKS

Sensing opportunities, seizing them, and transforming the organization to fit.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Hard to measure; critics say the idea can be circular.

AT GREENLEAF

GreenLeaf's HR must be able to sense when a tool fails and transform its model, not only buy the next tool.

THEORY IN DEPTH · MARCH (1991)

Exploration and exploitation compete for resources

THE CORE IDEA

Exploitation refines what works; exploration searches for what might work better.

HOW IT WORKS

Exploitation pays quickly and surely; exploration pays slowly and uncertainly, so firms under-explore.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

The right balance depends on the environment, and is hard to set in advance.

AT GREENLEAF

Fund a few small pilots each year alongside fixing the core record: exploration and exploitation together.

THEORY IN DEPTH · MINTZBERG AND WATERS (1985)

Strategy is partly planned and partly emergent

THE CORE IDEA

Realized strategy combines deliberate plans with patterns that emerge from action.

HOW IT WORKS

Good managers learn from emergent patterns and fold them into the plan.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Too much emergence can become drift without direction.

AT GREENLEAF Round 3 adoption data were emergent signals. A good strategy changes in response.

THEORY IN DEPTH · RIES (2011)

Build, measure, learn

THE CORE IDEA

The lean startup: test ideas with a minimum viable product, measure, learn, and pivot or persevere.

HOW IT WORKS

Each cycle is small and fast, with a metric and a decision rule set before the test.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Built for start-ups; large firms must adapt it to governance and compliance.

AT GREENLEAF

This is Lewin's controlled unfreeze turned into a habit: every HR pilot has a metric and a stop rule.

TAKEAWAYS

Three things to carry out of this lecture

1

A strategy is who decides, how money flows and what is measured.

2

Small tested steps build resilience and agility.

3

Plan deliberately, and learn from what emerges.

NEXT HR as digital change agent.